

STAY STEADY.

YOUR FALLS & BALANCE GUIDE

Eight simple exercises, one 4-week plan, and the confidence to keep doing everything you love — on your own two feet.



Created by Accredited Exercise Physiologists

SOUTH HOBART · LINDISFARNE

1 in 3

adults over 65 fall each year

2×

lower fall risk with strength & balance training

8

exercises you can do at home today

FALLS AREN'T BAD LUCK.

Most falls come down to two things: leg strength and balance. Both are things you can change, at any age.

1/3

Roughly one in three adults aged 65 and over falls each year, and falls are a leading cause of injury-related hospital visits in this age group.

1

LEGS GET WEAKER

Leg strength fades quietly with age, so chairs and stairs start to feel harder.

2

BALANCE SLOWS DOWN

Reactions dull, so a small stumble is more likely to become a fall.

3

DOING LESS MAKES IT WORSE

Avoiding movement costs you more strength – and more confidence.

MYTH VS FACT

MYTH

Falls are just part of getting older.

FACT

Most falls trace back to strength and balance – both of which you can change.

MYTH

I haven't fallen yet, so I don't need to worry.

FACT

Strength and balance fade quietly. Prevention works best before the first fall.

MYTH

Exercise is risky if I'm already unsteady.

FACT

Guided, gentle exercise is one of the safest ways to get steadier.

COULD THIS BE YOU?

✓ A stumble or near-fall in the last 12 months

✓ You hold onto furniture or walls at home

✓ Stairs and uneven ground feel unsteady

Ticked one? That's a reason to start, not a reason to stop. Targeted strength and balance work is one of the most effective ways to cut fall risk.

FOUR THINGS IT DOES FOR YOU.

Leg strength and balance are the two biggest physical factors in staying upright. Both improve at any age with the right, gentle approach.

1

STEADIER STEPS

Leg strength is what gets you out of a chair, up the stairs, and back upright after a stumble.

2

QUICKER SAVES

Balance training sharpens the fast, small corrections that stop a stumble becoming a fall.

3

EVERYDAY CONFIDENCE

Uneven footpaths, stairs and shopping stop feeling like a gamble.

4

INDEPENDENCE FOR LONGER

Strong legs and steady balance keep you mobile in your own home.

YOUR BALANCE RUNS ON THREE SYSTEMS

Vision — reads the ground ahead

Inner ear — senses head movement

Muscles & joints — locate your body

Strength, balance and gentle mobility together are the most effective way to reduce fall risk. Start gently, stay consistent, build up slowly.

WEEKS 1-2

Better movement awareness and confidence

WEEKS 3-6

Noticeable gains in leg strength

WEEKS 6-12

Measurable improvement in balance and stability

DO THESE AT HOME.

Eight gentle, beginner-friendly moves for lower body strength and balance. Keep a sturdy chair or bench within reach for every one of them.

1

SIT TO STAND TO SIT

Stand up fully from a sturdy chair, then lower back down with control. Use the chair or bench for support if you need it.

2-3 sets of 8-10 reps

2

HEEL + TOE RAISE

Holding the bench, rise onto your toes, then rock back and lift your toes off the floor, balancing on your heels.

2-3 sets of 10-12 reps

3

SIDE STEPPING

Holding the bench for support, step sideways with control, then bring your feet back together and repeat.

2 sets of 8-10 steps each way

4

TANDEM STANDING

Stand with one foot directly in front of the other, heel to toe, holding a chair or bench to steady yourself.

3 × 10-20 seconds each side

5

SINGLE LEG BALANCE

Hover your hand near the bench without touching it, then lift one foot slightly off the floor.

3 × 10-15 seconds each side

6

BALANCE | FORWARD REACH

Standing tall near a chair or bench, reach one arm forward as far as is comfortable, then return to standing.

2 sets of 8-10 reps each side

7

BALANCE | SIDE REACH

Standing tall near a chair, reach one arm out to the side as far as is comfortable, then return to centre with control.

2 sets of 8-10 reps each side

8

MARCHING AT THE BENCH

Holding the bench if needed, lift your knees to hip height one at a time in a gentle marching rhythm.

2-3 sets of 20-30 seconds



BEFORE YOU START

Clear the space of trip hazards, wear supportive flat shoes, and keep a sturdy chair or bench within reach. Stop immediately if you feel dizzy, unsteady or unwell. If you have a health condition, have had a recent fall, or feel unsure, check with your doctor or an Accredited Exercise Physiologist first.

THREE DAYS A WEEK.

Consistency beats intensity, every time. Start here and progress gradually as strength and confidence build.

DAY	FOCUS	WHAT TO DO
MONDAY	Strength	Sit to Stand to Sit + Heel & Toe Raise + Side Stepping
WEDNESDAY	Balance	Tandem Standing + Single Leg Balance + Forward Reach + Side Reach + Marching
FRIDAY	Full routine	All eight exercises at a gentle pace, focusing on control
EVERY DAY	Movement	A short walk, if it's comfortable and safe to do so

WEEK 1-2

Nail the technique. Take full support from a chair or wall. Quality over quantity.

WEEK 3-4

Reduce hand support where it's safe, add one or two reps per set, hold balances longer.

BEYOND

A supervised, progressive program with your HEP Exercise Physiologist keeps the gains coming, safely.

FROM YOUR HEP TEAM

READY FOR A PROGRAM BUILT AROUND YOU?

Every body is different. Book a session at South Hobart or Lindisfarne and we'll build a falls-prevention program around your strength, your balance and your goals.

BOOK ONLINE

www.hobartexercisephysiology.com.au

WHERE THIS COMES FROM.

Every recommendation in this guide is drawn from peer-reviewed research and professional body position statements.

- 01** Tiedemann, A., Sturnieks, D.L., Burton, E., Thom, J.M., Lord, S.R., Scott, S. & Sherrington, C. (2025) 'Exercise and Sports Science Australia updated position statement on exercise for preventing falls in older people living in the community', *Journal of Science and Medicine in Sport*.
- 02** Exercise & Sports Science Australia (2011) *Position statement: exercise and falls prevention in older people*. Available at: essa.org.au (Accessed: 2026).
- 03** Exercise Right (2025) *Falls Prevention* [Factsheet]. Exercise & Sports Science Australia. Available at: exerciseright.com.au (Accessed: 2026).
- 04** World Falls Guidelines Task Force (2022) 'World guidelines for falls prevention and management for older adults', *Age and Ageing*, 51(9).

A NOTE ON ADVICE

This guide is for general education and is not a substitute for individual medical or clinical advice. Speak with your doctor or an Accredited Exercise Physiologist before starting a new exercise program, particularly if you have a health condition or have fallen recently.